

scripts/run-electron.cjs

Kind: modified · Baseline: 9aadd5eb5604 · Target: NovaDiff · Generated: 2026-05-26T07:30:03.859Z

Overview

The dev launcher now attempts to install the Electron binary automatically when it is missing. A synchronous `spawnSync` call runs `node_modules/electron/install.js` before launching the binary.

Key changes

- **Import update** – `spawnSync` added to `node:child_process` (L11).
- **resolveElectronBinary (L24-41)**
 - Checks for `install.js` under `node_modules/electron`.
 - If the binary path file (`path.txt`) is absent, it runs `install.js` via `spawnSync` with `cwd: root` and `env: cleanEnv()`.
 - Throws a detailed error if the installer is missing or the install fails, referencing the auto-install failure path (L38-41).
 - The original missing-file error (L26-28) is now only used when the installer itself is missing.
- **Binary resolution** remains unchanged after the install step (L43-53).

Impact

- **Correctness** – The launcher now attempts to ensure the binary exists before launch, reducing the need for a manual `npm install`.
- **Performance** – A synchronous spawn occurs only on the first run when the binary is absent; subsequent runs skip this step.
- **Observability** – New error messages provide clearer guidance when auto-install fails.

Risks & follow-ups

- **Startup latency** – The synchronous install may delay launch; verify acceptable timing in CI and local dev.
- **Node compatibility** – `spawnSync` is available on recent Node versions; confirm support on older LTS releases (unknown from the diff).
- **Installer presence** – The code assumes `electronPkg/install.js` exists; add a guard if it disappears in future Electron releases.
- **Error handling** – Ensure the new error messages surface correctly in logs and do not mask underlying install failures.